



RESEARCH SOURCES

FOR BETTER RESEARCH ON APPS LIKE STACK

25 LINKS · 2 GROUPS

Stack mixes **news cards**, **music**, **PDF reading** and **notes**. No single app does all four, so these sources cover each slice: **12 apps and reviews** to learn what users expect, and **13 build guides** for the features planned next. Every title and link in this PDF is clickable.

NEWS CARDS

READ-LATER & NOTES

FOCUS & MUSIC

PDF & READING

01—SIMILAR APPS

WHAT TO LEARN FROM EACH · 12 SOURCES

01

NEWS CARDS

Inshorts — News in 60 words

India's top short-news app (10M+ daily users). Study its swipe cards, topic picks, Hindi support and breaking-news alerts.

[PLAY.GOOGLE.COM/STORE/APPS/DETAILS?ID=com.nis.app](https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.nis.app)

02

NEWS CARDS

How Inshorts used AI (WAN-IFRA)

How the 60-word AI summaries (Rapid60) were trained and scaled. The model for Stack's planned card summaries.

[WAN-IFRA.ORG · HOW-INSHORTS-USED-AI](https://wan-ifra.org/how-inshorts-used-ai)

03

READ-LATER & NOTES

Readwise Reader

The most complete read-later app: articles, RSS, PDFs, highlights, text-to-speech and an AI reading assistant (\$12.99/mo).

[READWISE.IO/READ](https://readwise.io/read)

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READ-LATER & NOTES

Readwise Reader docs

Feature-by-feature detail: highlighting, Ghostreader AI, TTS, exports to Notion/Obsidian. A checklist for Stack's notes.

[DOCS.READWISE.IO/READER](https://docs.readwise.io/reader)

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READ-LATER & NOTES

Best read-it-later apps 2026 (Mente)

Honest comparison after Pocket and Omnivore shut down: Readwise, Matter, Instapaper and more, with prices.

[GETMENTE.COM/BLOG/BEST-READ-IT-LATER-APPS-2026](https://getmente.com/blog/best-read-it-later-apps-2026)

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READ-LATER & NOTES

Omnivore alternatives 2026 (Readless)

7 tested apps, free and paid. Shows which features people missed most when Omnivore closed.

[READLESS.APP/BLOG/OMNIVORE-ALTERNATIVE-S-2026](https://readless.app/blog/omnivore-alternative-s-2026)

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FOCUS & MUSIC

FocusTune

Pomodoro timer + lofi music + to-do list. The closest idea to Stack's planned Focus session.

[PLAY.GOOGLE.COM · COM.STUDY.FOCUSTUNE.MUSIC](https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.study.focustune.music)

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FOCUS & MUSIC

Focus Study

Study timer with notes for every session, streaks and a tracker. Ideas for Stack's reading stats.

[PLAY.GOOGLE.COM · COM.FOCUSSTUDY](https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.focusstudy)

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PDF & READING

ElevenReader

Reads documents aloud with natural voices. The benchmark for Stack's planned Listen mode.

[ELEVENREADER.IO](https://elevenreader.io)

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PDF & READING

Best PDF readers for Android

Android Authority's round-up of PDF apps (Moon+ Reader and others) and the features they compete on.

[ANDROIDAUTHORITY.COM · BEST-PDF-READERS-FOR-ANDROID](https://androidauthority.com/best-pdf-readers-for-android)

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NEWS CARDS

The 5 best news apps in 2026 (Zapier)

What a modern news app needs: personalisation, offline reading, audio briefings and AI summaries.

[ZAPIER.COM/BLOG/BEST-NEWS-APPS](https://zapier.com/blog/best-news-apps)

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NEWS CARDS

News aggregator apps compared (daily.dev)

10 aggregators tested side by side: feeds, sources, filtering. Useful for Stack's topic and source choices.

[DAILY.DEV · BEST-NEWS-AGGREGATOR-APPS](https://daily.dev/best-news-aggregator-apps)



02—BUILD GUIDES

OFFICIAL DOCS FOR THE NEXT UPDATES · 13 SOURCES · TAGGED BY ROADMAP PHASE

PHASE 1 · FINISH

PHASE 2 · UNIQUE FEATURES

PHASE 3 · SMARTER READING

FOUNDATION (ALL PHASES)

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FOUNDATION

Capacitor docs

How the web code becomes the Android app: plugins, native bridge, builds. Everything native in Stack starts here.

[CAPACITORJS.COM/DOCS](https://capacitorjs.com/docs)

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PHASE 3

Capacitor Local Notifications

Scheduling, permissions and exact vs inexact alarms. Powers the daily digest and future news alerts.

[CAPACITORJS.COM/DOCS/APIS/LOCAL-NOTIFICATIONS](https://capacitorjs.com/docs/apis/local-notifications)

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PHASE 1

Spotify Web API

Login (PKCE), playlists, Liked Songs, player control. Includes development-mode user limits.

[DEVELOPER.SPOTIFY.COM/DOCUMENTATION/WEB-API](https://developer.spotify.com/documentation/web-api)

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PHASE 1

Spotify Android SDK (App Remote)

Controls the Spotify app directly from Stack, which removes the "no active device" problem.

[DEVELOPER.SPOTIFY.COM/DOCUMENTATION/ANDROID](https://developer.spotify.com/documentation/android)

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PHASE 2

Android Media3

Background playback and the media notification (used for phone music now, and for Listen mode next).

[DEVELOPER.ANDROID.COM/MEDIA/MEDIA3](https://developer.android.com/media/media3)

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FOUNDATION

Android: manage all files

The "All files access" permission, and Google Play's rules for it. Needed before a Play Store release.

[DEVELOPER.ANDROID.COM · MANAGE-ALL-FILES](https://developer.android.com/permissions/permissions)

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PHASE 2

Android: receive shared content

How Stack appears in Android's share menu, the base of "Share to Stack" (read later from any app).

[DEVELOPER.ANDROID.COM/TRAINING/SHARING/RECEIVE](https://developer.android.com/training/sharing/receive)

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PHASE 3

Android WorkManager

Reliable background jobs: fetch news every few hours and send breaking-news alerts per topic.

[DEVELOPER.ANDROID.COM · WORKMANAGER](https://developer.android.com/work/workmanager)

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FOUNDATION

Android splash screens

Animated icons, timing and dark mode for the launch screen (the logo drop animation follows this).

[DEVELOPER.ANDROID.COM · SPLASH-SCREEN](https://developer.android.com/launch-screen)

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PHASE 3

Gemini API

Free-tier AI for 60-word card summaries and "explain this" on selected text.

[AI.GOOGLE.DEV/GEMINI-API/DOCS](https://ai.google.dev/gemini-api/docs)

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FOUNDATION

pdf.js

Mozilla's PDF engine behind Stack's reader: rendering, the text layer for highlights, the legacy build for older phones.

[MOZILLA.GITHUB.IO/PDF.JS](https://mozilla.github.io/pdf.js)

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FOUNDATION

Mozilla Readability

Turns any news page into clean reader-mode text (the same library as Firefox Reader View).

[GITHUB.COM/MOZILLA/READABILITY](https://github.com/mozilla/readability)

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FOUNDATION

Next.js static exports

How the same Next.js code is exported as a static bundle for the APK, and what that rules out (no server routes).

[NEXTJS.ORG/DOCS/APP/GUIDES/STATIC-EXPORTS](https://nextjs.org/docs/app/guides/static-export)

WHERE TO START

1. **Readwise Reader** (03) for how reading, highlights and notes fit together.
2. **Inshorts** (01) for news cards that people use every day.
3. **Spotify Android SDK** (16), because it unlocks Phase 1: Spotify playing inside Stack.